

S.3 HISTORY — FINAL EXAMINATION

PASS NOTES — The Minimum You Must Know

International Conflicts in the 20th Century — The Two World Wars

How to use: these notes cover only the four hinted areas — (1) the three triangles, (2) the chronological order of WWII incidents, (3) the impact of WWII (DBQ 3), and (4) the Berlin Blockade map (p. 122). Memorise everything here and you can secure the core marks.

1 · The Three Triangles — Party · Leader · Symbol

Totalitarianism = a system in which the ruler holds total authority over the state and controls all aspects of public and private life.

Country	Party / Ideology	Leader	Symbol
Italy	Fascist Party — Fascism	Mussolini	fasces
Germany	Nazi Party — Nazism	Hitler	swastika
Japan	Shintoism (state religion) — Militarism	Tojo Hideki / Emperor Showa	Rising sun



The three totalitarian regimes: Fascism (Italy), Nazism (Germany) & Militarism (Japan)

Exam tip: if asked to identify a regime from a source, look for the symbol or leader, then name the country + ideology + leader as a set (e.g. swastika → Germany, Nazism, Hitler).

2 · Chronological Order of Important Incidents

(a) Germany's expansion in Europe (Research Exercise 10)

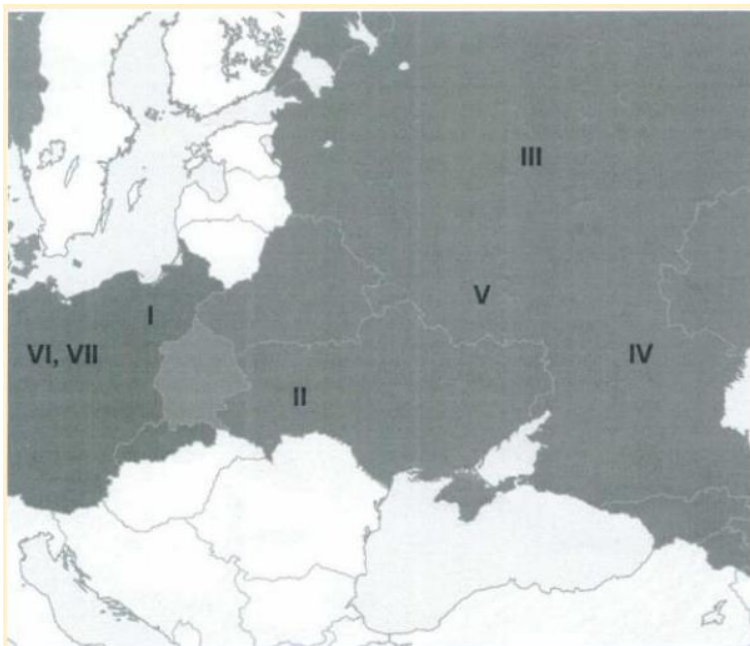
Step	Event
I	Remilitarisation of the Rhineland (Mar 1936) — violated the Treaty of Versailles
II	Anschluss (Mar 1938) — annexation of Austria
III	Sudetenland Crisis (Sept 1938) — Munich Agreement signed
IV	Invasion of Czechoslovakia (Mar 1939) — appeasement abandoned
V	Invasion of Poland (Sept 1939) — Nazi–Soviet Pact signed; WWII began

(b) Japan's expansion in Asia (Research Exercise 9)

Step	Event
1	Shenyang (Mukden) Incident (1931) — invaded Manchuria
2	Attacked Shanghai (1932) — retreated under British/French/US pressure
3	Establishment of Manzhouguo (Manchukuo) (1932)
4	Lugouqiao (Marco Polo Bridge) Incident (1937) — full-scale invasion of China
5	Second Sino-Japanese War (1937–1945)

(c) The Eastern Front (Research Exercise 11)

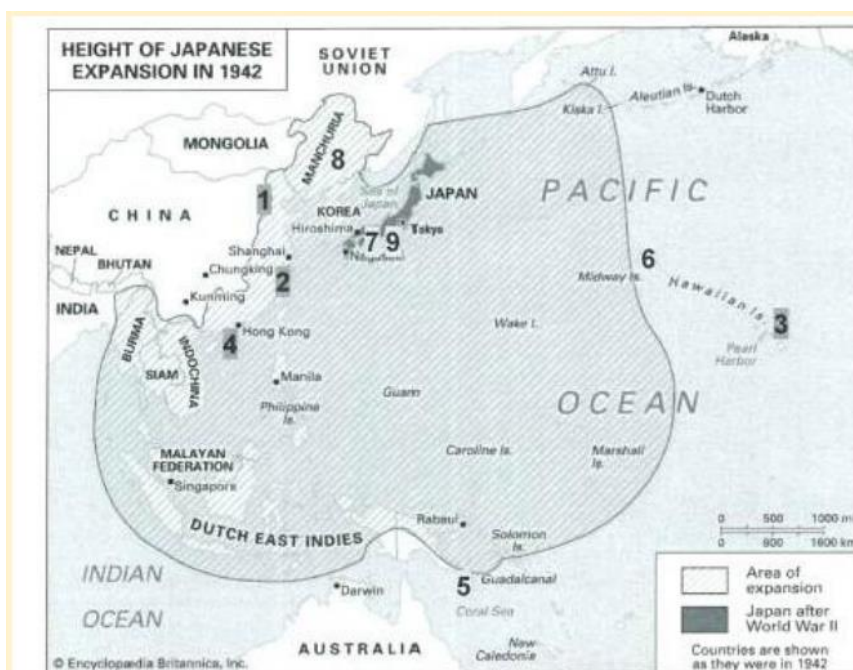
Step	Event
I	German invasion of Poland (Sept 1939) — WWII broke out
II	Operation Barbarossa (1941) — Germany invaded the Soviet Union
III	Battle of Moscow (1941–42) — ended the idea of a fast German victory
IV	Battle of Stalingrad (1942–43) — first major German defeat (turning point)
V	Battle of Kursk (1943) — largest tank battle in history
VI	Battle of Berlin (1945) — street-by-street fighting
VII	Unconditional surrender of Germany (May 1945) — end of WWII in Europe



The Eastern Front — match each numbered location (I–VII) to the events above

(d) The Asia-Pacific Theatre (Research Exercise 12)

Step	Event
1	Marco Polo Bridge (Lugouqiao) Incident (July 1937) — Second Sino-Japanese War began
2	Nanjing Massacre (Dec 1937) — over 200,000 killed
3	Pearl Harbour Incident (Dec 1941) — Pacific War broke out
4	Battle of Hong Kong (Dec 1941) — Britain lost HK in 3 weeks
5	Battle of the Coral Sea (May 1942) — Japanese advance first stopped
6	Battle of Midway (June 1942) — turning point; all 4 Japanese carriers destroyed
7	Atomic bombings of Hiroshima & Nagasaki (6 & 9 Aug 1945)
8	Soviet invasion of Manchuria (Aug 1945) — Kwantung Army defeated
9	Unconditional surrender of Japan (15 Aug 1945) — WWII ended



The Asia-Pacific theatre — match each numbered location (1–9) to the events above

(e) Master timeline — both theatres combined

Date	Incident	Theatre
July 1937	Lugouqiao Incident — Second Sino-Japanese War begins	Asia-Pacific
Dec 1937	Nanjing Massacre	Asia-Pacific
1 Sept 1939	German invasion of Poland — WWII broke out	Europe
1941	Operation Barbarossa — Germany invaded the USSR	Europe
1941–42	Battle of Moscow	Europe
Dec 1941	Pearl Harbour; Battle of Hong Kong	Asia-Pacific
May 1942	Battle of the Coral Sea	Asia-Pacific
June 1942	Battle of Midway — turning point (Pacific)	Asia-Pacific
1942–43	Battle of Stalingrad — turning point (Eastern Front)	Europe
1943	Battle of Kursk — largest tank battle	Europe
May 1945	Battle of Berlin; Germany surrendered — end of WWII in Europe	Europe
6 & 9 Aug 1945	Atomic bombings of Hiroshima & Nagasaki	Asia-Pacific
Aug 1945	Soviet invasion of Manchuria	Asia-Pacific
15 Aug 1945	Japan surrendered — the Second World War ended	Asia-Pacific

Must memorise the two turning points: Eastern Front — **Stalingrad (1942–43)**; Asia-Pacific — **Midway (June 1942)**.

3 · The Impact of the Second World War (DBQ 3)

(a) Total deaths: WWI vs WWII (Source A)

	First World War	Second World War
Total deaths	about 19 million	about 85 million (4× larger)
Worst-hit country	Russia — about 3.3 million	Soviet Union — about 27 million

- **Similarity:** Russia / the Soviet Union suffered the most in both wars.
- **Difference:** WWII was far deadlier — about 85 million deaths, roughly four times WWI's ~19 million.

(b) Why was WWII deadlier? (2 points)

- **Larger area of fighting:** not confined to Europe — the Asia-Pacific region was also a major battlefield.
- **More destructive weapons:** new weapons such as the atomic bomb (Hiroshima & Nagasaki) caused destruction never seen before.

(c) The three main impacts (model answer)

Impact	Evidence / explanation
1. Casualties & destruction	Over 85 million killed (Source A); cities and economies devastated.
2. Start of the nuclear age	The atomic bomb was first invented and used by the US in 1945 (Source B) on Hiroshima & Nagasaki; world nuclear stockpiles then grew.
3. Rise of two superpowers & decline of Europe	The US and the USSR rose as superpowers; European powers (Britain & France) lost most colonies and became second-rank powers.

Answer frame: state the impact → quote the source (Source A / Source B) → explain in one sentence. Always give all three impacts.

4 · The Berlin Blockade Map (p. 122)

Only the map is in scope. After WWII, Germany and Berlin were each split into four occupation zones (US, Britain, France, USSR). Berlin sat deep inside the Soviet zone. During the 1948–49 Berlin Blockade, the USSR cut land and water routes into West Berlin; the Western powers supplied it by air through the air corridors.



Administration of Berlin & the Berlin Blockade (1948–49) — Source 10.11, textbook p. 122



Inset: Berlin divided into West Berlin & East Berlin

What you must be able to read from the map

- **The four zone colours:** blue = American, green = British, orange = French, pink = Soviet.
- **Berlin's location:** deep inside the Soviet zone — this is why the blockade could cut it off.
- **The arrows:** air corridors from Hamburg, Hanover and Frankfurt into West Berlin (the Berlin Airlift).
- **The inset:** West Berlin = US + British + French zones; East Berlin = Soviet zone; dashed line = West Berlin boundary.